

LIVE

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NEWSPAPER

5th December, 2017

ITEM WISE EDITORIALS

49th WEEK



YEMEN CIVIL WAR... BATTLEGROUND

UPSC CSE – GS III

**GS III... EFFECT OF POLICIES AND POLITICS OF
DEVELOPING COUNTRIES ON INDIA**



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LIVE



NEWSPAPER EDITORIALS ... DISCUSSION

5th DECEMBER, 2017

2

Forgotten war

Yemen is on the brink of a huge famine; the world community must force a ceasefire

For the past 22 months, Saudi Arabia has been bombing Yemen with help from its Western allies, turning the country into a humanitarian tragedy. Yemen is now on the brink of "the world's largest famine", according to the United Nations. Already, 17 million people are dependent on external aid for food and medicine, while the country is fighting a massive cholera outbreak. The breakdown of government services, lack of drinking water and a crumbling health sector, besides the miseries of civil war and aerial bombardment, are fast turning Yemen into a failed state, and a breeding ground for extremist groups such as al-Qaeda in the Arabian Peninsula. The Saudis say they are fighting Houthis rebels on behalf of the "legitimate" government of Yemen led by Abdu Rabu Mansour Hadi. But the facts are more complicated. When Yemen plunged into chaos after the resignation of President Ali Abdullah Saleh in 2012, Houthi rebels mobilised forces and captured the capital city Sana'a and western parts of the country. Saudi Arabia, which shares a long border with Yemen, was wary of the rising influence of the Shia Houthis, who it sees as Iran-sponsored militia. The Saudis formed a coalition of anti-Shi'a Sunni groups in Yemen and provided them with money and weapons, while its warplanes started attacking Houthi positions in March 2015. The war has dragged on ever, with Sana'a still under Houthi control.

Saudi Arabia appears desperate to change the outcome of the war: this explains its decision last month to impose a blockade on the country in the midst of a severe food crisis. Though it eased the blockade later due to international pressure, the war still rages. It is high time the Saudis and the Houthis came to terms with reality. Houthi leadership and loyal support among Shias and perhaps some more from Israh, but it is unclear whether they are capable of controlling the whole of Yemen and uniting its diverse population. On the other side, Saudi Arabia has allies on the ground and superior air power, but it has still failed to defeat the Houthis. In recent weeks, the Saudis had reached out to Saleh, whose loyalists were fighting alongside the Houthis, in an apparent bid to break the rebel coalition. But a day after Saleh expressed readiness for talks with Riyadh, Houthis claimed to have killed him on Monday, escalating the civil war. To break this cycle, all warring parties, including the Houthis, the Saleh faction, Houthi's loyal to President Hadi and Saudi Arabia should move towards talks. Till now, the international community has largely looked away. It cannot continue to do so. Allies should put pressure on Riyadh to cease the bombing, and set the stage for talks between the Saudis.



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THE HINDU
INDIA'S NATIONAL NEWSPAPER SINCE 1878

Date : 5th December, 2017



2 Forgotten war

Yemen is on the brink of a huge famine — the world community must force a ceasefire

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...Contd.

2 Forgotten war

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CURRENT AFFAIRS



YEMEN ...FORGOTTEN CRISIS



30th WEEK 2016

UPSC

CAPSULE - 5

ALL EXAMS

25th July to 31st July

- Republic of Yemen
 - Arab country in West Asia
 - Part of Arabian Peninsula
 - Borders Saudi Arabia & Oman
 - North Yemen and South Yemen unified to become Yemen in 1990.
 - Coastline of around 2,000 kms
- Capital ... Sana'a,
Aden (Hadi Govt.)
 - Largest City ... Sana'a
 - Official Language ... Arabic
 - Religion ... Islam
 - Population ... Around 25 million
 - Currency ... Yemeni rial
 - One of the poorest Arab countries



SAUDI ARABIA

OMAN

ERITREA

DJIBOUTI

ETHIOPIA

Red Sea

Gulf of Oman

SANA'A

YEMEN

ADEN





CRISIS IN YEMEN ...PART OF ARAB SPRING

1

“Street Protests” in January 2011 took place against poverty, corruption, lack of democracy, human rights abuses etc.



ALI ABDULLAH SALEH

1st President of Yemen
1990 - 2012



CRISIS IN YEMEN ...PART OF ARAB SPRING

2

In 2012, after lot of protests and uprisings by the public and after desperate attempts to stay in power failed, President Ali Abdullah Saleh resigned and Abd Rabbuh Mansur Hadi became the new President in 2012.



ABD RABBUH MANSUR HADI

President since 2012



CRISIS IN YEMEN ...PART OF ARAB SPRING

3

In 2015, Houthis revolted and power sharing deal with Houthis failed and Hadi fled to Saudi Arabia and returned back to Aden to establish Govt. with the support of Saudi Arabia. Sana'a is under the control of Houthis.



ABD RABBUH MANSUR HADI



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ADEN



CRISIS IN YEMEN ...PART OF ARAB SPRING

4

In March 2015, Saudi Arabia and its allies launched air strikes on Houthi rebels in Yemen.





PRESENT SCENARIO IN 2017

Air strikes on Yemen are going on since March 2015 ...



ABD RABBUH MANSUR HADI,

President based in Aden supported
by Saudi Arabia & Allies .

Saudi Arabia



HOUTHI REBELS

Occupied parts of Yemen along with
Sana'a and allegedly supported by Iran.



Iran



AGAIN THE FIGHT BETWEEN IRAN AND SAUDI ARABIA !



GROUP 1



HOUTHI REBELS



SUPPORTED BY
IRAN

GROUP 2



HADI GOVERNMENT



SAUDI ARABIA AND SUNNI
ARAB ALLIES



US, UK AND FRANCE



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UNITED NATIONS



WHAT HAPPENED DURING THE PAST 2½ YEARS?

- 1 Both the sides suffered because of the fighting for the past 2½ years.
- 2 Three UN organised efforts to negotiate a peace deal have failed.
- 3 Hadi Government established a temporary home in Aden.
- 4 Most of the Cabinet Ministers remained in exile.
- 5 Houthis have not been dislodged from Sana'a.
- 6 Jihadi militants Al-Queda in the Arabian Peninsula (AQAP) and Islamic State have taken advantage of the chaos and continuously carried out deadly attacks.



IMPACT ON CIVILIANS

1 UN Human Rights Council has called it as unrelenting violations of International Humanitarian Law.

2 More than 5,000 civilians have been killed.

3 Saudi led coalition air strikes are the leading cause of child fatalities.

4 More than 20 million people, including 11 million children are in need of urgent humanitarian assistance.

5 Severe acute malnutrition is threatening almost 4 lakh children.

6 The World's largest cholera outbreak in recent times resulted in more than 2,200 deaths.

7 2 million Yemenis are internally displaced.



WHAT ARE THE MAIN CONCERNS?

- 1 As the country is becoming more and more unstable, there is every possibility that AQAP and the emergence of IS affiliates is a serious cause of concern.
- 2 The conflict is part of regional power struggle between Shia ruled Iran and Sunni ruled Saudi Arabia.
- 3 Yemen is strategically important because it sits on the Bab-el Mandeb Strait, a narrow water way linking Red Sea with Gulf of Aden through which substantial percentage of World's oil shipments pass.



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SINCERE THANKS
FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

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